Using co-design workshops to explore community needs and future directions for shared electric mobility hubs

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Abstract

Railway stations, bus stops, post offices and similar facilities can often provide an important focus for communities, including as a central hub for the movement of people and goods, and as a place of social interaction. Recent research directions have emphasised the 'Place' function of road (and other transport) facilities as a vital and additional dimension alongside the more traditional focus of transport systems for through movement and more local access to adjoining land uses. Shared e-mobility hubs are a relatively new development in transport, and seek to provide a central location at which travellers and nearby residents might have access to electric cars, e-cargo bikes, e-bikes or other modes that might support more sustainable travel choices, especially in contexts where the provision of high frequency transit services may be challenging (e.g. regional towns, rural communities, low-density suburbs). However, it is unclear form such shared e-mobility hubs should take, and the extent to which the co-location of other (e.g. library, café, bus stop, community house) might enhance usage, safety and security, and local communities. Four shared e-mobility hubs have recently been implemented in Letterkenny, Galway, Waterford and the suburbs of Dublin. These include e-bikes, e-cargo bikes, and shared electric cars as part of the 'base' offering, but it is unclear what additional mobility, community-focused, commercial or other offerings might be desired by communities, or might help to support the use of shared e-mobility hub facilities to improve transport sustatinability. This paper reports the findings from co-design creative workshops held in Letterkenny, Galway, Waterford and Dublin to explore community attitudes

and concepts as to how the 'base' shared e-mobility hub might be enhanced so as to better meet each community's transport and other needs. The cross-case comparisons reported in this paper might provide policy-makers, practitioners and researchers further insights into the types of offerings that might be provided at shared e-mobility hubs and other transport facilities in a variety of contexts (small town, secondary town centre, suburban locations etc.) so as to enhance the sustainable mobility and community outcomes of transport facility development.

Keywords:

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1. Introduction

Appendix A. Example Appendix Section

Appendix text.
Example citation, See **?**.